

Global Top 25 Peptides in Demand and 2025–2026 Product News

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Executive summary

Global peptide demand is highly concentrated. **Tirzepatide and semaglutide are the two dominant growth franchises**, while insulin analogues remain the largest durable essential-use peptide/protein class by patient need and treatment volume. Eli Lilly reported combined 2025 Mounjaro and Zepbound revenue of approximately **US\$36.5 billion**, and Novo Nordisk reported exceptionally large semaglutide sales across Ozempic, Wegovy and Rybelsus. In Q2 2026, Lilly reported US\$9.9 billion for Mounjaro and US\$4.9 billion for Zepbound, while Novo reported more than five million US Wegovy-pill prescriptions since its January 2026 launch. [1](#) [2](#)

Beyond metabolic medicines, major established demand pools include **long-acting somatostatin analogues, fertility hormones, GnRH agonists, growth-hormone products, linacotide, teduglutide, teriparatide and oncology radioligands**. Novartis reported 2025 sales of approximately US\$2.0 billion for Pluvicto, US\$1.2 billion for Sandostatin and US\$816 million for Lutathera. [5](#) Merck reported a €1.46 billion fertility franchise, while Ironwood reported 234 million Linzess capsules demanded in the United States during 2025. [6](#) [7](#)

The most important **newly approved or launched products** include oral Wegovy, ICOTYDE/icotrokinra, weekly Awiqli insulin, Yuviwel/navepegritide, Forzinity/elamipretide, Kyinsu/IcoSema and several China-approved incretin peptides. The most closely watched **not-yet-approved** assets include retatrutide, CagriSema, survodutide, MariTide, lutetium-177 edotreotide, efruxifermin, pegozafermin and apraglutide. These pipeline assets have prospective demand, not lawful commercial demand.

The clearest lawful non-prescription categories are **hydrolysed collagen peptides** and **topical cosmetic peptide ingredients**. By contrast, BPC-157, TB-500, CJC-1295, ipamorelin, melanotan and online “research” retatrutide show grey-market attention rather than approved clinical demand. Regulators have highlighted safety, quality, advertising and enforcement concerns, and several are prohibited in sport.^{36 37 38 39}

1. How the Top 25 was determined

There is no authoritative public database that measures exact worldwide units across prescription medicines, cosmetics, foods, supplements and unapproved research products. Those markets use incompatible units and have very different evidence quality. The ranking below is therefore a **demand-signal ranking**, not a claim of exact market share.

The ranking gives greatest weight to verified commercial scale or prescription adoption, followed by geographic availability, persistence of clinical use, breadth of approved indications, manufacturing or capacity signals and current growth. A high-priced rare-disease product can generate substantial revenue at low physical volume; conversely, an essential generic peptide can have high unit demand but limited public sales disclosure. These distinctions are stated in the table.

The main Top 25 is focused on **regulated therapeutic peptides and closely related peptide/protein biologics**. Product-family groupings are used where global demand is spread across many brands, such as insulin analogues and fertility hormones. Radioligands, glycoprotein hormones and cyclic polypeptides are labelled where they sit at the boundary of a narrow “synthetic peptide” definition.

2. Top 25 peptide medicines and product families in global demand

Rank	Molecule or product family	Common products	Main demand area
1	Tirzepatide	Mounjaro; Zepbound	Diabetes, obesity and obesity-associated OS/

2	Semaglutide	Ozempic; Wegovy injection; Wegovy pill; Rybelsus	Diabetes, obesity, cardiovascular-risk reduction, CKD and US MASH
3	Insulin analogues	Insulin glargine, degludec, aspart and lispro products; Lantus, Toujeo, Tresiba, NovoRapid, Fiasp, Humalog and biosimilars	Type 1 and type 2 diabetes
4	Dulaglutide	Trulicity	Type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular-risk reduction
5	Octreotide and lanreotide	Sandostatin, Sandostatin LAR, Somatuline, Oczyesa, Mycapssa	Neuroendocrine tumours, acromegaly and hormone-symptom control
6	Lutetium-177 vipivotide tetraxetan	Pluvicto	PSMA-positive prostate cancer
7	Recombinant fertility hormones	Gonal-f, Pergoveris, Ovidrel/Ovitrelle, Follistim/Puregon, Bemfola and Ovaleap	IVF and reproductive endocrinology

8	Teduglutide	Gattex; Revestive	Short-bowel syndrome dependent on parenteral support
9	Linacotide	Linzess; Constella	IBS-C and chronic/functional constipation
10	Liraglutide	Victoza; Saxenda; generic liraglutide	Diabetes and, for relevant brands, weight management
11	Vosoritide	Voxzogo	Achondroplasia
12	Lutetium-177 dotatate	Lutathera	Somatostatin-receptor-positive neuroendocrine tumours
13	Growth-hormone replacement products	Genotropin, Norditropin, Humatrope, Saizen, Omnitrope; weekly Skytrofa, Sogroya and Ngenla	Paediatric and adult growth-hormone deficiency
14	GnRH agonists	Leuprolide/Lupron/Eligard; goserelin/Zoladex;	Prostate cancer, selected gynaecological

		triptorelin/Trelstar/Decapeptyl	indications and central precocious puberty
15	Palopegteriparatide	Yorvipath	Chronic hypoparathyroidism
16	Teriparatide	Forteo/Forsteo, Movymia, Terrosa, Livogiva and follow-ons	High-fracture-risk osteoporosis
17	Bivalirudin	Angiomax and generic/ready-to-use bivalirudin	Procedural anticoagulation during PCI
18	Voclosporin	Lupkynis	Active lupus nephritis
19	Pasireotide	Signifor; Signifor LAR	Cushing disease and acromegaly
20	Afamelanotide	Scenesse	Erythropoietic protoporphyria

21	Insulin icodec	Awikli	Once-weekly basal insulin for diabetes
22	Icodec–semaglutide combination	Kyinsu; IcoSema	Type 2 diabetes requiring escalation from basal insulin or GLP-1 treatment
23	Elamipretide	Forzinity	Barth syndrome
24	Icotrokinra	ICOTYDE	Moderate-to-severe plaque psoriasis
25	Navepegritide	Yuviwel	Achondroplasia in eligible children

Important products not cleanly ranked

Oxytocin, desmopressin, glucagon and several other hospital or essential-care peptides are widely used, but public global product-level revenue and unit data are too fragmented for a defensible relative rank. Their absence from the table must not be interpreted as low clinical importance. The WHO Model List is an access and public-health priority framework, not a commercial ranking.⁴¹

3. Most common non-prescription and online-market peptide categories

These categories should not be combined with the prescription Top 25. Their evidence, legal pathways, customers and quality requirements differ substantially.

Category	Common names or examples	Demand interpretation	Commercial and regulatory conclusions
Hydrolysed collagen peptides	Peptan; Rousselot and PB Leiner ingredients; bovine, porcine and marine collagen hydrolysates	The strongest evidenced lawful non-drug category. A proposed Rousselot–PB Leiner combination was described as an approximately US\$1.5 billion annual-revenue gelatin/collagen business with about 200,000 tonnes of capacity. ³²	Potential food, beverage, sports-nutrition and supplement opportunity, subject to source traceability, safety, claims, allergen, religious-certification and South African food/supplement regulations. The disclosed figures include gelatin, not collagen peptides.
Topical cosmetic signal and carrier peptides	Matrixyl family; palmitoyl tripeptide-5/SYN-COLL; copper peptide/GHK-Cu in topical cosmetics	Moderate established global visibility in mass and premium skincare. Peptide-specific sales are rarely disclosed, so supplier launches and retail presence are directional rather than exact demand measures. ³³	A cosmetic ingredient, not an approved medicine. Claims for efficacy remain cosmetic and a finished product requires safety substantiation and regulatory compliance. ³⁴
BPC-157 and TB-500	BPC-157; thymosin-beta-4/TB-500; “Wolverine Stack”	High online attention and material grey-market circulation, but negligible verified lawful clinical demand. Seizures and border interception demonstrate enforcement exposure, not efficacy or legitimate adoption. ³⁶ ³⁷	High legal, product liability, quality, and doping and reputation risk. BPC-157 and TB-500-related substances are prohibited in sports under relevant WADA categories. ³⁹
CJC-1295 and ipamorelin	Stand-alone products and combinations promoted for anti-	Moderate-to-high online attention without a verified approved	FDA has highlighted limited information on significant safety concerns.

	ageing, bodybuilding or wellness	prescription market for these named products.	characterisation concerns; WADA prohibits these substances in sport. ³⁹
Melanotan tanning products	Melanotan I/II nasal sprays and injections	Strong social-media visibility but no verified lawful tanning-product demand in the cited markets.	Must not be confused with approved afamelanotide for erythropoietic protoporphyria. Regulators warn against unsafe products. ³
Online “research” retatrutide and other pipeline molecules	Retatrutide sold before approval; investigational incretin/amylin compounds	Attention reflects publicity around clinical trials, not lawful commercial demand.	Retatrutide was not approved anywhere. The research cut-off. Online sale does not create a legitimate medicine market. ¹

The key distinction is that **popularity is not authorisation**. Cosmetics are not automatically regulator-approved, dietary supplements are not medicines, and a research label does not make human-use promotion or supply lawful.^{34 35}

4. The latest approved and launched peptide products

The following are among the most consequential recent approvals, launches and label expansions identified between January 2025 and 18 August 2026.

Date	Product	Geography and event	Why it is significant
26 Mar 2026	Awikli (insulin icodec)	US FDA approval for adults with type 2 diabetes	First US once-weekly basal insulin; enters an enormous mature insulin market. ¹¹
18 Mar 2026	ICOTYDE (icotrokinra)	US FDA approval for labelled adults and adolescents with plaque psoriasis	First IL-23R-targeted oral peptide, opening a major non-metabolic oral-peptide category. ¹³
6 Mar 2026	Ecnoglutide	China approval for chronic weight	Creates a dual diabetes/obesity

		management, following January diabetes approval	franchise for a differentiated domestic GLP-1 peptide. 18 19
27 Feb 2026	Yuviwel (navepegritide)	US accelerated approval for eligible children with achondroplasia	New once-weekly CNP option; early launch, with confirmatory obligations. 15
5 Jan 2026	Wegovy pill	US commercial launch after 22 Dec 2025 FDA approval	First approved oral GLP-1 medicine for weight management; rapid initial prescription adoption. 21
24 Nov 2025; expanded in 2026	Kyinsu/IcoSema	EU approval, followed by Japan and China approvals	First-wave weekly fixed combination of insulin icodec and semaglutide. 12
19 Sep 2025	Forzinity (elamipretide)	US accelerated approval for Barth syndrome	First approved treatment for this ultra-rare mitochondrial disorder. 14
19 Sep 2025	Mazdutide	China approval for type 2 diabetes after June 2025 obesity approval	First approved dual glucagon/GLP-1 agonist with two major metabolic indications in China. 17
15 Aug 2025	Wegovy injection	US accelerated approval for MASH with moderate-to-advanced fibrosis	Expands semaglutide into a common progressive liver disease; confirmatory outcomes remain required. 20
30 Jun 2025	Oczyesa (octreotide)	EU authorisation for maintenance treatment of responsive/tolerant adults with acromegaly	Adds a prolonged-release, potentially patient-administered formulation to a mature class. 42

27 Jun 2025	Mazdutide	China approval for chronic weight management	First marketed dual glucagon/GLP-1 agonist for this indication in China. 17
11 Jun 2025	Efsubaglutide alfa	China approval for type 2 diabetes	Adds a domestic long-acting GLP-1–Fc fusion product. 16
28 Mar 2025	Pluvicto	US indication expansion into selected pre-taxane patients	Moves a fast-growing radioligand earlier in the prostate-cancer treatment pathway. 43
14 Feb 2025	Merilog	US approval of the first rapid-acting insulin biosimilar	Confirms continuing large insulin demand while increasing price competition. 4
28 Jan 2025	Ozempic	US CKD risk-reduction label expansion	Extends semaglutide demand into kidney outcomes for eligible patients. 44

5. Latest pipeline products to watch

Product	Modality and target market	Status at 18 Aug 2026	Demand interpretation
CagriSema	Cagrilintide/semaglutide amylin–GLP-1 combination for obesity and diabetes	US obesity application submitted in December 2025; not approved at cut-off. 25	Near-term high prospective demand, but differentiation was complicated by failure to establish non-inferiority to tirzepatide in REDEFINE 4.
Lutetium-177 edotreotide / ITM-11	Peptide-receptor radionuclide therapy for GEP-NETs	FDA accepted the NDA; PDUFA goal date was 28 Aug 2026, after this report’s cut-off. 27	One of the closest potential new peptide-radiopharmaceutical launches; approval was still uncertain at cut-off.

Retatrutide	Triple GIP/GLP-1/glucagon agonist for obesity and related diseases	Phase 3 registration package reported complete; Lilly planned a US BLA in Q1 2027. ¹ ²²	Probably the strongest unapproved future-demand signal, but zero lawful commercial demand at cut-off.
Survodutide	Glucagon/GLP-1 agonist for obesity, MASLD and MASH	Phase 3; not approved. ²⁴	Differentiated by liver and visceral-fat programme; approval and hard-outcome evidence remain outstanding.
MariTide	Monthly peptide–antibody conjugate for obesity	Phase 3 programme after Phase 2 results; not approved. ²⁶	Strong prospective interest based on less-frequent administration, but no approved market.
Efruxifermin	Long-acting FGF21 analogue for MASH	Phase 3; not approved	High strategic interest in MASH, with long development and outcomes risk.
Pegozafermin	Long-acting FGF21 analogue for MASH and severe hypertriglyceridaemia	Phase 3 under Roche/Genentech; not approved	Acquisition value supports strategic interest, not patient demand.
Apraglutide	Once-weekly GLP-2 analogue for short-bowel syndrome	Confirmatory Phase 3 required; not approved. ²⁸	Potential convenience advantage over teduglutide, but regulatory delay and execution risk are material.
GUB014295	Long-acting amylin analogue	Phase 1 at AbbVie licensing; not approved. ²⁹	Large deal values show business-development demand, not commercial demand.
HS-20094 and Metsera portfolio	GLP-1/GIP, GLP-1 and amylin programmes	Clinical-stage and unapproved at the relevant deals. ³⁰ ³¹	Confirms continued industry consolidation around differentiated metabolic peptides.

6. Verified 2025–2026 peptide news tracker

Date	Product or category	News event	Status at the time	Source
17 Aug 2026	BPC-157/TB-500, CJC-1295 and purported retatrutide	Australian seizure linked to alleged online/social-media sale	Unapproved/illicit products; enforcement event, not a launch	TGA ³⁷
5 Aug 2026	Retatrutide	Lilly said the global registration package was complete and planned a Q1 2027 US filing	Investigational; not approved	Lilly ¹
27 May 2026	Linzess	US paediatric functional-constipation label expansion	Approved product; broader labelled population	Ironwood ⁴⁵
21 May 2026	Retatrutide	Pivotal Phase 3 obesity readout	Investigational; not approved	Lilly ²²
26 Mar 2026	Awikli	US weekly basal-insulin approval	Approved in the US for labelled adults with type 2 diabetes	FDA ¹¹
18 Mar 2026	ICOTYDE	US plaque-psoriasis approval	Newly approved oral peptide	Johnson & Johnson ¹³
6 Mar 2026	Ecnoglutide	China weight-management approval	Approved in China; not automatically elsewhere	Sciwind ¹⁹
27 Feb 2026	Yuwiwel	US accelerated approval	Approved with confirmatory obligations	Ascendis ¹⁵
23 Feb 2026	Voxzogo	BioMarin reported US\$927 million 2025 sales	Marketed in 55 markets	BioMarin ¹⁰

11 Feb 2026	Yorvipath and Skytrofa	Ascendis reported rapid 2025 commercial growth	Approved products	Ascendis ⁹
2 Feb 2026	CagriSema	Phase 3 diabetes results and submission update	Submitted/investigational; not approved	Novo Nordisk ²⁵
30 Jan 2026	Ecnoglutide	China diabetes approval	Approved in China	Sciwind ¹⁸
5 Jan 2026	Wegovy pill	US commercial launch	Approved oral obesity medicine	Novo Nordisk ²¹
22 Dec 2025	Wegovy pill	US FDA approval announced	Approved in the US; other jurisdictions separate	Novo Nordisk ²¹
22 Sep 2025	Metsera portfolio	Pfizer announced proposed acquisition	Pipeline portfolio; not approved products	Pfizer ³¹
19 Sep 2025	Forzinity	US accelerated approval for Barth syndrome	Newly approved ultra-rare medicine	FDA ¹⁴
15 Aug 2025	Wegovy injection	US accelerated approval for MASH	Approved new US indication; confirmatory study required	FDA ²⁰
30 Jun 2025	Oczyesa	EU marketing authorisation	Approved acromegaly medicine	EMA ⁴²
27 Jun 2025	Mazdutide	China obesity approval	Approved in China	Innovent ¹⁷
23 Jun 2025	MariTide	Full Phase 2 obesity results and Phase 3 expansion	Investigational; not approved	Amgen ²⁶
11 Jun 2025	Efsubaglutide alfa	China marketing approval	Approved in China	NMPA ¹⁶

2 Jun 2025	HS-20094	Regeneron in-licensing transaction	Investigational; not approved	Regeneron 30
12 May 2025	Collagen/gelatin category	Proposed Rousselot–PB Leiner combination	Industry-consolidation proposal, not a medicine launch	Darling Ingredients 32
4 Apr 2025	SYN-COLL CB	Global cosmetic ingredient launch	Cosmetic active, not an approved therapeutic product	dsm-firmenich 33
3 Mar 2025	GUB014295	AbbVie/Gubra amylin licensing agreement	Phase 1; not approved	AbbVie 29
28 Jan 2025	Ozempic	US CKD indication expansion	Approved new US indication	FDA 44

7. Implications for George in South Africa

The biggest global-demand categories are **not the easiest entry categories**. Tirzepatide, semaglutide, insulin, radioligands, fertility hormones and specialist endocrine medicines require authorised supply chains, product registration or other lawful pathways, licensed activities, pharmacovigilance, validated cold chain and professional oversight. They are not suitable for informal ecommerce procurement.

SAHPRA's published GLP-1 position warned about compounded, substandard and falsified products and emphasised product-specific registration and authorised indications. 40 The business must therefore treat foreign sales success, FDA/EMA/NMPA approval and South African authorisation as separate questions. A product approved for obesity in the United States or China is not automatically registered for that use in South Africa.

For George, the most defensible opportunity screens are:

Opportunity screen	Strategic interpretation
Clinician/pharmacy channel	Focus only on products and indications confirmed in the current SAHPRA register and supplied through an authorised chain. Commercial partnerships are more realistic

	than independent peptide importing for high-complexity medicines.
Cosmetic channel	Topical peptide skincare may be commercially relevant, but therapeutic, wound-healing, fat-loss or disease claims can change the regulatory category. Formulation safety and compliant claims matter more than the popularity of an ingredient name.
Food/supplement channel	Hydrolysed collagen has the strongest lawful non-drug demand evidence. Source traceability, contaminant controls, animal-source declarations, claims, labelling and food/supplement classification require validation.
Research-supply channel	Institutional non-clinical demand must be objectively verified and separated from human-use promotion. “Research use only” wording is not a defence for a disguised wellness or treatment business.
Avoid/hold channel	BPC-157, TB-500, CJC-1295, ipamorelin, melanotan and pre-approval retatrutide carry disproportionate regulatory, safety, anti-doping, quality and reputational risk. Online demand should not be converted into a purchase decision.

The immediate commercial action should be a **South African product-status and channel screen** for a short list, rather than buying the global Top 25. The screen should record the exact active ingredient, formulation, brand, manufacturer, intended use, claims, customer, SAHPRA status, licence requirements, import pathway, storage condition, independent testing requirement, landed cost and lawful marketing route.

8. Conclusion

The global peptide market is led by a small number of highly scaled regulated medicines, particularly tirzepatide, semaglutide and insulin products. The next layer consists of durable specialist franchises in oncology, endocrinology, fertility, gastrointestinal disease and rare disease. The innovation pipeline is increasingly focused on **oral delivery, weekly or monthly dosing, multi-agonist metabolic peptides, amylin combinations, MASH, radioligands and long-acting rare-disease replacement therapies**.

For George, the correct business response is not to replicate the global popularity list as a catalogue. It is to use the ranking as an opportunity map, then pass each candidate through the established product-classification, supplier, quality, import, cold-chain and claims gates. The most commercially visible molecule can still be the wrong product if the lawful South African channel, authorised source, unit economics or operational controls are absent.

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